

Recognizing Phishing & Psychological Triggers

TOPIC: ONLINE SCAMS | CLASSIFICATION: PUBLIC DEFENSE GUIDE

Understand how modern cybercriminals exploit urgency, authority, and curiosity to deceive even tech-savvy individuals.

Key Defensive Principles & Takeaways:

- 1 Artificial Urgency Red Flags**
"Your account will be suspended in 24 hours" is designed to trigger emotional panic before rational inspection.
- 2 Inspect the Raw Sender Domain**
Examine the actual SPF/DKIM return-path domain, not the cosmetic display name in your mail client.
- 3 Homoglyph & Punycode Attacks**
Recognize substituted Unicode characters (e.g. Cyrillic "C " &W Æ 6—ær Æ F—â & "' —â 7 öö`ed URLs.
- 4 Out-Of-Band Verification**
Always contact financial institutions or colleagues via a known, pre-established phone number, never the link provided.

DEFENDER VERIFICATION STAMP

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